

FLL ROOKIE SEASON ROADMAP

"Discovery First, Trophy Second" — A Growth Contract for 6 Families

I. The Core Philosophy: A Growing Mindset

Our team embraces **Gracious Professionalism** and **Coopertition**. This season is not about winning; it is about the transition from play to engineering. We value **process over outcome**.

The Parent Mantra: *"The kids do the work."* We provide the scaffolding, but the kids build the bridge.

II. 12-Week Precision Roadmap

Phase 1: Foundation & Mechanical Literacy (Weeks 1-3)

- **Kickoff:** Establish Team Contract and review the **Robot Game Rulebook**.
- **Analysis:** Identify "Low-Hanging Fruit" missions vs. "High-Risk" challenges.
- **The Build:** Construct a stable drivetrain and learn **Engineering Notebook** curation.

Phase 2: The Engineering Design Process (Weeks 4-7)

- **Coding:** Intro to sensors (Color, Gyro). Begin **Innovation Project** problem identification.
- **Outreach:** Parents facilitate 1-2 expert interviews to validate the kids' solutions.
- **Iteration:** Build attachments and test for **Consistency** (Reliability > Complexity).

Phase 3: Integration & Performance (Weeks 8-12)

- **The Drill:** Practice 2.5-minute match runs. Draft the 5-minute project presentation.
- **Mock Judging:** Use official **FLL Rubrics** to practice answering "Why" and "How."
- **The Event:** Tournament day is a celebration of resilience and discovery.

III. The 6-Family Collaborative Model

Role	Responsibility
Technical Coach (A)	Lead Robot Design & Mechanical Engineering.
Coding Coach (B)	Software Logic, Mission Sequencing, & Debugging.
Project Lead (C)	Research, Expert Outreach, & Presentation Coaching.
Ops & Admin (D)	Budget, Registration, Kits, & Official Communication.
Culture & Logistics (E)	Snacks, Core Values Team Building, & Space Setup.
Media & Documentation (F)	Engineering Notebook, Photos, & Poster Design.

IV. Critical Calendar & Holiday Alerts

Period	Status	Warning
Labor Day	Momentum Builder	Critical for finalizing the robot base.
Halloween	Deep Research	Focus on home-based project research.
Veterans Day	"The Red Zone"	Expect extra scrimmage sessions for tournament prep.
Thanksgiving	Tournament Window	Attendance Mandatory: Typical Qualifier timeframe.

Team & Family Commitment

We agree to support each other with respect, to celebrate our failures as learning points, and to ensure the kids own their designs. We commit to the schedule and to the spirit of FIRST.

Parent Signature

Student Signature